

QA LEADERSHIP ACADEMY

Module 9 Assignment — AI Strategy for QA Leaders

Assignment brief: scenario, deliverables, steps and how your work is assessed.

About this assignment

A couple of Northstar testers are already pasting code and tickets into public AI tools to work faster, with no policy governing what data goes where. This is a live governance risk at a company handling personal financial data, but banning it outright would waste a real productivity opportunity and simply push usage underground. You need to get ahead of the informal adoption with a proper strategy.

What you'll demonstrate

- Turn ungoverned AI use into a governed, deliberate capability
- Identify high-value, low-risk QA use cases for AI
- Put proportionate governance around data, verification and accountability
- Plan adoption as pilots rather than a big-bang rollout

What to submit

- A QA AI Strategy for Northstar
- An AI QA Use-Case Matrix and an AI Risk Assessment
- A completed AI Governance Checklist
- An AI Pilot Template and an AI Adoption Roadmap

Step-by-step

1. Map candidate QA uses for AI on the Use-Case Matrix, scoring value against risk
2. Complete the AI Risk Assessment, focusing on the data-exposure problem given Northstar handles personal financial information
3. Work through the AI Governance Checklist to define what data may be used, how output must be verified and who is accountable
4. Design one concrete pilot with the AI Pilot Template, with success criteria and guardrails

5. Assemble the strategy and Adoption Roadmap so informal use becomes governed use without a heavy-handed ban

Submission format

Submit as a PDF or DOCX presenting the strategy, use cases, risk assessment, governance and roadmap.

How your work is assessed

If a QA lead reviewed this, they would look for:

- A pragmatic stance that governs rather than bans
- Use cases chosen for real value, not novelty
- Serious treatment of data exposure given the financial-data context
- Clear accountability — a human remains responsible for AI-assisted output
- A pilot-first roadmap with measurable success criteria

Templates & resources to use

- AI QA Use-Case Matrix — find it in the Resource Vault.
- AI Risk Assessment — find it in the Resource Vault.
- AI Governance Checklist — find it in the Resource Vault.
- AI Pilot Template — find it in the Resource Vault.
- AI Adoption Roadmap — find it in the Resource Vault.

INSIDE STLC PRO TIP

People are already using AI whether you sanction it or not. A clear, permissive policy with real guardrails beats a ban that only drives the behaviour underground — especially when the data at stake is people's finances.